



German 101: Erste Woche an der Uni — A Full Introductions Session

German 101 • German

COURSE-OBJ.DE101.2

Use beginner German accurately to greet others, introduce yourself, ask and answer questions about origin, and describe simple daily activities. A complete 90-minute session packet with warm-up, guided practice, partner/lab work, independent practice, extension work, assessment, and a full answer key.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan the session

Course and objective

German 101 · German; COURSE-OBJ.DE101.2 — Introduce yourself and exchange basic personal information using greetings, pronouns, sein, heißen, and regular present-tense verbs.

What is included

Cover; instructor guide; key-term and concept preview; original reading or worked examples; warm-up (2 items); guided practice with organizer (4 items); partner/lab discussion (3 items); independent practice (6 items); small-group extension work (4 items); assessment; complete answer key; access and sources page.

Suggested pacing (90-minute session)

Warm-up 8 min · dialogue read-aloud + vocabulary 15 min · guided grammar organizer 20 min · partner role-play 15 min · independent practice 20 min · extension work 8 min · assessment 4 min.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from the answer key, or distribute through a secure LMS. Review the reading/examples and organizer before class. No paid textbook or app is required.

Student directions

Read or work through the material carefully. Support every answer with evidence, work shown, or clear reasoning.



Before you begin

Key terms

willkommen — welcome

woher kommen Sie / kommst du? — where are you from? (formal/informal)

ein bisschen — a little bit

seit zwei Jahren — for two years

wie geht es dir/Ihnen? — how are you? (informal/formal)

Anfängerin / Anfänger — beginner (f./m.)

vielleicht — maybe

zusammen lernen — to study together

Concept focus

Sein (to be) is irregular and essential to identity statements (ich bin, du bist, er/sie/es ist). Heißen (to be named) and kommen (to come) are regular weak verbs following the -e, -st, -t, -en, -t, -en pattern. German distinguishes formal Sie from informal du, and questions without a question word (yes/no questions) are formed by inverting the verb and subject.

Model 1 — Conjugate heißen for ich, du, and wir.

ich heiße, du heißt, wir heißen — regular weak-verb pattern with a spelling adjustment (ß after the stem vowel).

Model 2 — Why does German use "Sie" instead of "du" when a student first meets a new professor?

Sie is the formal form of "you," used with strangers, professors, and in professional contexts to show respect, while "du" is reserved for friends, family, and peers.

WARM-UP

Warm-up

Answer using what you already know or recall from the previous session.

1. What explicit question does Professor Braun ask when introducing the class, and to whom first?

2. What mistake does Professor Braun make and immediately correct in Part 1? What does this reveal about du vs. Sie?



Erste Woche an der Uni (Teil 1)

PROFESSOR BRAUN : Guten Morgen! Willkommen zum ersten Deutschkurs. Ich heiße Professor Braun. Und wie heißen Sie?

LEONIDAS : Guten Morgen, Professor Braun. Ich heiße Leonidas. Ich komme aus Griechenland.

PROFESSOR BRAUN : Sehr schön! Und woher kommst du — äh, entschuldigung, woher kommen Sie?

NAOMI : Ich heiße Naomi. Ich komme aus Kanada, aber meine Familie kommt aus Nigeria.

PROFESSOR BRAUN : Interessant! Sprechen Sie schon ein bisschen Deutsch, Naomi?

NAOMI : Ein bisschen. Ich lerne seit zwei Jahren Deutsch in der Schule.

PROFESSOR BRAUN : Ausgezeichnet. Und Sie, Leonidas — sprechen Sie andere Sprachen?

LEONIDAS : Ja, ich spreche Griechisch, Englisch, und ein bisschen Spanisch.

PROFESSOR BRAUN : Wunderbar. In diesem Kurs lernen wir zusammen. Sind Sie bereit?

LEONIDAS UND NAOMI : Ja, wir sind bereit!

Erste Woche an der Uni (Teil 2)

(Nach dem Unterricht sprechen Leonidas und Naomi miteinander.)

LEONIDAS : Hallo Naomi! Wie geht es dir?

NAOMI : Mir geht es gut, danke! Und dir?

LEONIDAS : Auch gut, danke. Du sprichst wirklich gut Deutsch für eine Anfängerin!

NAOMI : Danke schön! Aber ich mache noch viele Fehler. Zum Beispiel, ich vergesse oft die Artikel — der, die, das.

LEONIDAS : Ich auch! Das ist wirklich schwer. Lernst du jeden Tag?

NAOMI : Ja, ich lerne jeden Abend eine halbe Stunde. Und du?

LEONIDAS : Ich lerne meistens am Wochenende, aber vielleicht sollte ich das ändern.

NAOMI : Wir könnten zusammen lernen! Das hilft oft mehr als allein lernen.

LEONIDAS : Gute Idee! Bis morgen dann, Naomi.

NAOMI : Bis morgen! Tschüss!

Partner / lab discussion

Discuss each item with a partner or lab group before writing a joint response.

1. What grammatical structure does "seit zwei Jahren" (for two years) illustrate about German time expressions?

2. In Part 2, what informal greeting do Leonidas and Naomi use with each other, and how does it differ from Part 1's greetings?

3. What specific mistake does Naomi say she often makes, and why is this mistake understandable for a beginner?

Independent practice

Work independently. Show your work or cite evidence in every answer.

1. What study habit does Naomi describe, and how does it differ from Leonidas's habit?

2. What suggestion does Naomi make at the end of Part 2, and why might this be effective for language learning?

3. Translate: "Ich lerne seit zwei Jahren Deutsch."



Independent practice

Work independently. Show your work or cite evidence in every answer.

4. Write a two-line formal introduction using Sie, following the pattern in Part 1.

5. Write a two-line informal exchange using du, asking and answering "How are you?"

6. Explain, in English, the difference between "ich heiße" and "ich bin" when introducing yourself.



Small-group extension work

Use for review or additional application practice.

1. Rewrite Leonidas's line "Ich spreche Griechisch, Englisch, und ein bisschen Spanisch" using "auch" (also) to add a fourth language of your choice.

2. Why might this two-part dialogue (formal classroom introduction, then informal peer conversation) be useful for practicing register in German?

Small-group extension work

Use for learners ready for additional challenge or synthesis.

1. Identify one cognate (word that looks similar in English and German) in the dialogue and explain how recognizing cognates can help beginners.

2. Write a full four-line dialogue, in German, in which two students meet for the first time and exchange names, origins, and a closing.



Assessment

Complete independently to show what you learned today.

1. Explain why "sprechen" changes its stem vowel in the du and er/sie/es forms (du sprichst, er spricht) but not in the wir or Sie forms.



Assessment · self-assessment

Rate today's work:

4 — I can teach this to someone else.

3 — I can do this independently.

2 — I can do this with help.

1 — I need to revisit this before the next session.



Answer key

1. "Und wie heißen Sie?" (And what is your name?), asked to Leonidas.
2. The professor starts to say "kommst du" (informal) then corrects to "kommen Sie" (formal), showing that even native speakers can slip, but the formal register is expected between a professor and new students.
3. He is from Greece (Griechenland); he speaks Greek, English, and a little Spanish.
4. She is from Canada, but her family comes from Nigeria — showing origin and family heritage can differ.
5. ich komme ("Ich komme aus Griechenland"), sie kommt ("meine Familie kommt aus Nigeria" — third person singular), wir kommen — regular weak-verb pattern.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

6. Two years; "Ich lerne seit zwei Jahren Deutsch in der Schule."

7. German uses "seit" (since/for) with a time period to describe an action that started in the past and continues into the present, similar to English "I have been learning for two years."

8. They use "du" (informal "you"): "Wie geht es dir?" instead of the formal "Sie" used with Professor Braun, reflecting their peer relationship.

9. She often forgets the articles der, die, das; this is understandable because German nouns have three genders that must be memorized individually, unlike English, which has only "the."

10. Naomi studies every evening for half an hour; Leonidas mostly studies on weekends — Naomi's practice is more frequent and consistent.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

11. She suggests they study together; studying together can provide practice speaking aloud, mutual correction, and accountability, all useful for language acquisition.

12. I have been learning German for two years.

13. Answers vary; must use "Sie" correctly, e.g., "Guten Tag, wie heißen Sie?" / "Ich heiße [name]. Ich komme aus [place]."

14. Answers vary; must use "du" correctly, e.g., "Wie geht es dir?" / "Mir geht es gut, danke."

15. "Ich heiße" specifically means "I am called/named," used for stating one's name, while "ich bin" (I am) is more general and can be followed by other descriptions, like a profession or nationality — both can introduce oneself but "heißen" is specific to naming.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

16. Answers vary; must correctly place "auch," e.g., "Ich spreche auch ein bisschen Französisch."

17. It lets students see the same two characters use different pronouns and tone depending on their relationship with the listener, making the formal/informal distinction concrete rather than abstract.

18. Answers vary; e.g., "Familie" (family) or "Idee" (idea) — recognizing cognates can help beginners guess meaning quickly and build vocabulary confidence before full grammar mastery.

19. Answers vary; must include a greeting, a name exchange using heißen, an origin statement using kommen aus, and an appropriate closing (formal or informal, but consistent).

20. Sprechen is a strong verb with a stem-vowel change (e→i) in the second- and third-person singular only; this irregular pattern must be memorized, unlike the fully regular weak-verb conjugations of heißen or kommen.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Access, sources, and license

Extension

Ask for a second method, a counterexample, or a short student-led extension of the concept, with a brief explanation of the choice.

Accommodated seating/504

Follow the individual accommodation plan: extended time, breaks, enlarged print, reduced copying, or an alternate response method as documented.

Additional support

Pre-teach key vocabulary or notation before class. Model the first guided item aloud. Accept oral or dictated responses when appropriate.

Multilingual learners

Preview key terms with examples. Allow brief first-language discussion before independent writing. Provide sentence or solution starters.

Course-level alignment · accessed September 18, 2026

COURSE-OBJ.DE101.2 — Introduce yourself and exchange basic personal information using greetings, pronouns, sein, heißen, and regular present-tense verbs. The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the course-level goal.

Course-level learning objective written for this packet; no accreditation, transfer credit, or universal course-equivalency is claimed.

Original reading(s)/worked examples, questions, and answer explanations. No textbook or copyrighted course material reproduced.

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